

Measured Misconduct

Scene Adaptation from Shakespeare's Measure for Measure, Act 2, Scene 2

Characters on screen: Angelo and Isabella

Projected Text Source: President Donald Trump, Harvey Weinstein, Danny Masterson

[Scene Introduction]

Setting: an enclosed white cube.

Action: Isabella has come to plead with Angelo for her brother Claudio's life.

Projection Note: Throughout the scene, real-world statements made by President Trump, Harvey Weinstein and Danny Masterson are projected on the white walls. These statements are timed to sync with Shakespeare's lines and to interrogate themes of power, coercion, and misogyny.

Content Warning: This scene includes references to sexual violence and abusive language.

[Video: Black screen. White text fades in: "Measured Misconduct: Larry, Harvey, Angelo et al." Text fades to black.]

[Video: Black Screen. White text fades in "Shakespeare's Measure for Measure (Act 2, Scene 2)". Text fades to blank.]

[Video: Fade in. Angelo stands in a room surrounded by off-white walls. He has slick black hair, a scruffy beard, and wears a blue suit and tie, the sleeves rolled up to his elbows. His stance is firm, legs slightly apart, holding a clipboard. Across the space, Isabella—dressed entirely in black—stands in the right corner with her back to him.]

Angelo (spoken):

What's your will?

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and positioned beside Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior."

[Video: Isabella turns her head, glancing over her left shoulder.]

Isabella (spoken):

I am a woeful suitor to your Honor,
Please but your Honor hear me.

[Video: Isabella turns her head, facing the wall once again.]

Angelo (spoken):

Well, what's your suit?

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and positioned beside Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice."

[Video: Isabella glances over her left shoulder at Angelo. He stands still, listening intently.]

Isabella (spoken):

I have a brother is condemned to die.
I do beseech you let it be his fault
And not my brother.

[Video: Isabella crawls forward on her hands and knees, approaching Angelo. He looks down at her, unmoving.]

Angelo (spoken):

Condemn the fault, and not the actor of it?
Why, every fault's condemned ere it be done.
Mine were the very cipher of a function
To fine the faults whose fine stands in record
And let go by the actor.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice. And for those who have been wronged and betrayed, I am your retribution."

[Video: Isabella, still on her hands and knees, glances up over her right shoulder at Angelo.]

Isabella (spoken):

Must he needs die?

[Video: Angelo turns his eyes away from Isabella and holds his hand out over her, as if to dismiss her presence.]

Angelo (spoken)

Maiden, no remedy.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice. And for those who have been wronged and betrayed, I am your retribution."

[Video: Isabella maintains eye contact with Angelo as she slowly begins to turn over, her expression unreadable.]

Isabella (spoken):

Yes, I do think that you might pardon him,

[Video: Isabella lies flat on the floor, looking up at Angelo as he looms over her.]

Isabella (spoken):

And neither heaven nor man grieve at the mercy.

[Video: Angelo abruptly dismisses Isabella. He straightens up, bringing his legs together, and raises a hand over her in a dismissive gesture.]

Angelo (spoken):

I will not do 't.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears to the right of Angelo's shoulder. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"This is beyond ridiculous."

[Video: Isabella sits up with her right leg extended and her left arm braced on the ground for support. She faces Angelo, her back to the camera.]

Isabella (spoken):

But can you if you would?

[Video: Angelo looks down at his clipboard, avoiding eye contact with Isabella. He waves a hand over her dismissively and then places hand in pocket.]

Angelo (spoken):

He's sentenced. 'Tis too late.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears to the right of Angelo's shoulder. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your justice."

[Video: Isabella kneels before Angelo. He looks down at her and smirks, stepping in closer with his legs apart. One fist clenched at his hip.]

Isabella (spoken):

Too late? Why, no.

Well believe this: Not

[Video: Angelo releases fist and places his hand over his mouth]

Isabella (spoken):

The marshal's truncheon, nor the judge's robe

Become them with one half so good a grace as mercy does.

[Video: Angelo places a hand over his heart. Isabella extends her hand, touching his chest just beneath his own. Slowly, her hand glides down his body before she pulls it away.]

Isabella (spoken):

If he had been as you, and you as he,
You would have slipped like him, but he like you
Would not have been so stern.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears to the right of Angelo's shoulder. It displays the following quote from Harvey Weinstein:]

"I didn't do anything wrong. I mean, I might have done some things that are immoral. But I didn't do anything that was illegal."

[Video: Angelo tucks the clipboard under his arm and brings his hands together in a prayer-like position. He then abruptly throws his hands apart above Isabella, as if to shoo her away.]

Angelo (spoken):

Pray you begone.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears to the right of Angelo's shoulder. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"This is beyond ridiculous."

[Video: Isabella pushes up onto one knee and then stands, turning to face Angelo. She is positioned on the left, with Angelo on the right.]

Isabella (spoken):

I would to heaven I had your potency,
And you were Isabel. Should it then be thus?

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I've been railroaded by this woman."

[Video: In the center of the room, Angelo and Isabella are still facing each other. Angelo raises his hand and sternly points a finger at her face.]

Angelo (spoken):

Your brother is a forfeit of the law
And you but waste your words.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I will beat her in court— and look forward to it."

[Video: A close-up of Isabella fills the frame. As the scene transitions, a layered overlay shows her advancing aggressively toward Angelo while he retreats, stepping backward.]

Isabella (spoken):

Alas, alas!
How would you be
If He which is the top of judgment should
But judge you as you are?

[Video: Cut to Isabella pinning Angelo in the corner. They are enclosed by stark white walls. Her left arm is braced against the wall, trapping him in place.]

[Projection: On the wall to their left, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I've been railroaded by this woman."

Isabella (spoken):

O, think on that,
And mercy then will breathe within your lips
Like man new-made.

[Projection: On the wall to their left, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I've been railroaded by this woman."

[Video: Angelo ducks beneath Isabella's left arm to evade her, crossing to the other side of the room. Isabella turns to follow him with her eyes, then leans back against the wall.]

[Projection: On the wall in between them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Harvey Weinstein:]

"I didn't do anything wrong. I mean, I might have done some things that are immoral. But I didn't do anything that was illegal."

Angelo (spoken):

Be you content, fair maid.
It is the law, not I, condemn your brother.

[Video: Isabella stands firm, one hand on her hip, the other on her thigh. With a slow, dismissive turn of her head, she looks away from Angelo.]

Angelo (spoken):

Were he my kinsman, brother, or my son,
It should be thus with him.

[Video: Close up of Angelo's face.]

Angelo (spoken):

He must die tomorrow.

[Video: Isabella turns her head slowly to face Angelo. One hand on her hip, the other resting on her thigh, she gradually slides down the wall in a controlled, deliberate motion.]

Isabella (spoken):

Tomorrow? O, that's sudden!

[Video: Cut to split screen. On the left, a close-up of Angelo's annoyed face. On the right, Isabella slowly slides down the wall.]

Isabella (spoken):

Spare him, spare him.

He's not prepared for death.

[Video: Cut to full screen. Isabella slowly slides back up the wall.]

[Projection: On the wall in between them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Harvey Weinstein:]

"I didn't do anything wrong. I mean, I might have done some things that are immoral. But I didn't do anything that was illegal."

Isabella (spoken):

Good, good my lord, bethink you.

Who is it that hath died for this offense?

There's many have committed it.

[Projection: On the wall in between them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"The public will finally be able to learn the truth and see how I've been railroaded by this woman"

[Video: Angelo mimics a judge's gavel with a firm hand gesture, then rests his hand on his head like a pillow. Unmoved, Isabella stands her ground—one hand on her hip, the other on her thigh—and slowly turns her head away in quiet dismissal.]

Angelo (spoken):

The law hath not been dead,

though it hath slept. Now 'tis awake,

Takes note of what is done, and, like a prophet,

[Projection: On the wall in between them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I will beat her in court— and look forward to it."

Angelo (spoken):

Looks in a glass that shows what future evils
Are now to have no successive degrees
But, 'ere¹ they live, to end.

[Video: Isabella begins to walk toward Angelo, who stands on the other side of the room.]

Isabella (spoken):

Yet show some pity.

[Video: With anger, Angelo thrusts a finger toward Isabella's face and advances on her aggressively, driving her backward until she is pressed into the corner.]

Angelo (spoken):

I show it most of all when I show justice,
For then I pity those I do not know,

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice. And for those who have been wronged and betrayed, I am your retribution. I am your retribution."

[Video: Isabella crashes into the corner and sinks to the floor. Angelo towers over her, his left hand pressed against the wall above her head, asserting control.]

[Sound: Hand slamming on wall.]

Angelo (spoken):

Your brother dies tomorrow; be content.

[Projection: On the wall beside them, white text appears. It still displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice. And for those who have been wronged and betrayed, I am your retribution. I am your retribution."

[Video: Isabella remains trapped in the corner beneath Angelo, who looms over her with his hand braced on the wall. Neither reveals emotion—their expressions unreadable, locked in tense stillness.]

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: Harvey Weinstein:]

"I didn't do anything wrong. I mean, I might have done some things that are immoral. But I didn't do anything that was illegal."

Isabella (spoken):

So you must be the first that gives this sentence,
And he that suffers. O, it is excellent

To have a giant's strength, but it is tyrannous

[Video: Angelo turns his back to Isabella and laughs to himself with a devilish grin, zipping up the fly of his pants. Isabella is on her knees moving closer to Angelo.]

Isabella (spoken):

To use it like a giant. Merciful heaven,
Thou rather with thy sharp and sulphurous bolt

[Video: While Isabella stays on her knees, rubbing her thighs and shifting her posture, Angelo calmly buttons his shirt and straightens his tie as he grins to himself. In the bottom left corner of the screen there is an overlay of Isabella's view of Angelo.]

Isabella (spoken):

Splits the unwedgeable and gnarlèd oak,
Than the soft myrtle. But man, proud man,

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: Harvey Weinstein:]

"I want this city to recognize who I was instead of what I've become."

[Video: While still on her knees, Isabella begins to move slowly towards Angelo. Angelo is smirking with satisfaction.]

Isabella (spoken):

Dressed in a little brief authority,
Most ignorant of what he's most assured,
Plays such fantastic tricks before high heaven
As makes the angels weep.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump.]

"The person who came up with the expression 'the weaker sex' was either very naive or had to be kidding."

[Video: Angelo side steps and points to himself, wearing a look that blends confusion and subtle arousal.]

Angelo (spoken):

Why do you put these sayings upon me?

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: Harvey Weinstein:]

"I came of age in the 60's and 70's, when all the rules about behavior and workplaces were different. That was the culture then. I have since learned it's not an excuse, in the office - or out of it. To anyone."

[Video: Isabella slowing rises to her feet and stands behind Angelo.]

Isabella (spoken):

Because authority, though it err like others,
Hath yet a kind of medicine in itself
That skins the vice o' th' top.

[Video: Still standing behind him, Isabella wraps her arms around Angelo, caressing his chest. He places his hands beneath hers, visibly reacting to her touch.]

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: Danny Masterson:]

"I have never been charged with a crime, let alone convicted of one."

Isabella (spoken):

Go to your bosom,
Knock there, and ask your heart what it doth know
That's like my brother's fault. If it confess
A natural guiltiness such as is his,
Let it not sound a thought upon your tongue Against my brother's life.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"All of the women on 'The Apprentice' flirted with me — consciously or unconsciously. That's to be expected."

[Video: Angelo gently covers Isabella's hand with his own, holding it in place over his heart.]

Angelo (spoken):

[Aside]

She speaks, and 'tis such sense
That my sense breeds with it.

[Video: Angelo abruptly releases her hand and begins to walk away.]

Angelo (spoken):

Fare you well.

[Video: Isabella reaches out and grabs Angelo's hand, pulling him back to her.]

Isabella (spoken):

Gentle my lord, turn back.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"Women have one of the great acts of all time."

[Video: Angelo breaks free from her grip, raises his hand to stop her, and begins to turn away again.]

Angelo (spoken):

I will bethink me. Come again tomorrow.

[Video: Once again, Isabella reaches out and grabs Angelo's hand.]

Isabella (spoken):

Hark how I'll bribe you.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"All of the women on 'The Apprentice' flirted with me — consciously or unconsciously. That's to be expected."

[Video: Isabella pulls Angelo in close to her.]

Isabella (spoken):

Good my lord, turn back.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"Women have one of the great acts of all time. The smart ones act very feminine and needy."

[Video: Angelo, shocked and annoyed, pulls away from Isabella.]

Angelo (spoken):

How? Bribe me?

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"The person who came up with the expression 'the weaker sex' was either very naive or had to be kidding."

[Video: Angelo throws the clipboard to the ground, then drops to his knees. He begins rubbing his genitals over his pants. Behind him, Isabella stands still before slowly stepping closer.]

Isabella (spoken):

Ay, with such gifts that heaven shall share with you. With true prayers That shall be up at heaven and enter there.

[Video: Angelo throws the clipboard to the ground, then drops to his knees. He begins rubbing his genitals over his pants. Behind him, Isabella stands still before slowly stepping closer.]

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"I have seen women manipulate men with just a twitch of their eye—or perhaps another body part."

[Video: While Angelo remains on his knees, rubbing his genitals over his pants, Isabella steps closer and begins massaging his shoulders.]

Isabella (spoken):

Ere sunrise, prayers from preservèd souls,
From fasting maids whose minds are dedicate
To nothing temporal.

Angelo (spoken):

Well, come to me tomorrow.

[Projection: On the wall behind them, white text appears. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"Women have one of the great acts of all time. The smart ones act very feminine and needy, but inside they are real killers."

Isabella (spoken):

Heaven keep your Honor safe.

[Video: Isabella slowly steps backward, pressing herself against the wall. Still on his knees, Angelo clasps his hands in a prayer-like gesture.]

Angelo (spoken):

Amen.

[Video: Isabella stands against the wall, with her eyes closed and her hands clasped above her head. Still on his knees and without looking back, Angelo points behind him toward her and then makes the sign on the cross.]

Angelo (spoken):

For I am that way going to temptation
Where prayers cross.

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind Angelo, positioned to the left of Isabella. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"You know, the dresses. You know, they're standing there with no clothes. . . And you see these incredible looking women, and so, I sort of get away with things like that. But no, I've been very good."

[Video: Still against the wall with her hands clasped above her head, Isabella doesn't move. On his knees, Angelo points behind him toward her once more, never turning to look.]

Angelo (spoken):

From thee, even from thy virtue.

[Video: Against the wall, Isabella stays frozen, hands clasped overhead. Angelo, still kneeling, raises his arms and strikes the backs of his hands against his thighs, framing his groin in a display of aggressive emphasis.]

[Sound: Sharp smack as his hands hit his thighs.]

Angelo (spoken):

What's this? What's this? Is this her fault or mine?

The tempter or the tempted, who sins most, ha?

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind Angelo, positioned to the left of Isabella. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"You know, I'm automatically attracted to beautiful — I just start kissing them. It's like a magnet."

[Video: Isabella and Angelo remain in their positions. Angelo gestures from Isabella to himself repeatedly, appearing deep in thought as if weighing a decision.]

Angelo (spoken):

Not she, nor doth she tempt; but it is I
That, lying by the violet in the sun,
Do as the carrion does, not as the flower,
Corrupt with virtuous season. Can it be
That modesty may more betray our sense
Than woman's lightness? Having waste ground enough,

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind Angelo, positioned to the left of Isabella. It displays the following quote from: Harvey Weinstein:]

"Though I'm trying to do better, I know I have a long way to go. That is my commitment. My journey now will be to learn about myself and conquer my demons."

[Video: Tension surges between them. Angelo grips his arm, thrusting a clenched fist into the air. Isabella responds instantly—one hand slams the wall, the other shields her body.]

[Sound: Loud impact of her palm against the wall.]

Angelo (spoken):

Shall we desire to raze the sanctuary
And pitch our evils there?

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind Angelo, positioned to the left of Isabella. It displays the following quote from: Louis CK:]

"I'm not condoning rape, obviously. You should never rape anyone. Unless you have a reason, like if you want to fuck somebody and they won't let you. In which case – what other option do you have? How else are you supposed to have an orgasm in their body if you don't rape them, like what the fuck."

Angelo (spoken):

O fie, fie, fie!

[Video: Isabella slides down the wall in a slow collapse, coming to rest on the floor. As Angelo stands, she begins to crawl toward him, eyes fixed ahead.]

[Projection: White text appears on the wall to the right of Angelo, positioned above Isabella. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"You know, I'm automatically attracted to beautiful — I just start kissing them. It's like a magnet. Just kiss. I don't even wait. And when you're a star, they let you do it. You can do anything. Grab 'em by the pussy. You can do anything."

Angelo (spoken):

What dost thou, or what art thou, Angelo?

Dost thou desire her foully for those things

That make her good? O, let her brother live.

[Video: Isabella rolls onto her back. Cut to a close-up of Angelo's face.]

Angelo (spoken):

Thieves for their robbery have authority

When judges steal themselves.

[Video: Angelo stands over Isabella, who lies still on the floor, hands clasped on her chest. He leans in, reaching down to softly touch her face.]

Angelo (spoken):

What, do I love her

That I desire to hear her speak again

And feast upon her eyes? What is 't I dream on?

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind them. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"Well, I'll tell you the funniest is that before a show, I'll go backstage and everyone's getting dressed, and everything else, and you know, no men are anywhere, and I'm allowed to go in because I'm the owner of the pageants and therefore I'm inspecting it. You know, I'm inspecting because I wasn't to make sure that everything is good."

[Video: Angelo remains standing over Isabella. He places his index and middle fingers at the corners of his mouth, then hooks one finger inside and lifts his head upward, mimicking a fish caught on a hook.]

Angelo (spoken):

O cunning enemy that, to catch a saint,
With saints dost bait thy hook.

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind them. It displays the following quote from: Louis C.K.:]

"The power I had over these women is that they admired me. And I wielded that power irresponsibly."

[Video: Angelo stands centered in the frame. Isabella's feet appear at the bottom edge of the screen, her body out of view, lying before him.]

Angelo (spoken):

Most dangerous
Is that temptation that doth goad us on
To sin in loving virtue. Never could the strumpet

[Video: The shot cuts to Angelo looming over Isabella, who remains on the floor, hands clasped on her chest. Slowly, he kneels down next to her.]

[Projection: White text appears on the wall to the right of Angelo, positioned above Isabella. It displays the following quote from: President Donald Trump:]

"You know, I'm automatically attracted to beautiful — I just start kissing them. It's like a magnet. Just kiss. I don't even wait. And when you're a star, they let you do it. You can do anything. Grab 'em by the pussy. You can do anything."

Angelo (spoken):

With all her double vigor, art and nature,
Once stir my temper, but this virtuous maid
Subdues me quite. Ever till now

[Video: Kneeling beside her, Angelo slowly runs his hand down Isabella's leg before lowering himself to lie at her side.]

Angelo (spoken):

When men were fond, I smiled and wondered how.

[Video: Fade to black.]